

MAYA MIKELSON

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Education

University of California, Berkeley
Ph.D. in Political Science

August 2025 – Present

University of Michigan – Ann Arbor
B.S. with High Honors in Political Science, minor in Data Science

August 2021 – May 2025

Research Interests

Conflict and cooperation, security studies, militarization, international interventions, human rights

Working Papers

Measuring Militarization and the Link with Interstate Conflict

Senior Honors Thesis, University of Michigan, Spring 2025

Third-Party Military Interventions, Government Repression, and Human Rights

Ralph Bunche Summer Institute Paper, June 2024

Militarization and Interstate Armed Conflict

NSF REU Accountability, Behavior & Conflict in Democratic Politics, July 2023

Research Experience

Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research

May 2022 – May 2025

↔ Professor Christopher J. Fariss

University of Michigan

- Developed latent variable models in R with the Stan library to calculate the likelihood of signing treaties in every year between 1966 and 2022.
- Coded a web scraper to analyze treaty ratification data from the UN Treaty Body database.

Ralph Bunche Summer Institute (RBSI)

May – June 2024

↔ Professors Paula D. McClain and David A. Siegel

Duke University

- Developed independent research project on the impact of third-party military interventions on human rights and government repression during intrastate conflict using a Heckman Probit Selection Model.
- Completed graduate-level courses in Race and American Politics and Probability and Regression.

NSF REU Accountability, Behavior & Conflict in Democratic Politics

June – July 2023

↔ Professor Emily Hencken Ritter

Vanderbilt University

- Developed an independent empirical project analyzing the relationship between militarization and interstate conflict that was presented in a poster session at APSA 2023, Los Angeles.
- Compiled historical sources into case studies examining race riots and police violence in the United States.

Teaching Experience

Graduate Student Instructor

University of California, Berkeley

- POLSCI 3: Introduction to Empirical Analysis and Quantitative Methods

Fall 2026

↔ Professor David Broockman

Conference Presentations

Peacekeeping, Conflict Government Repression, and Human Rights

Poster presentation at the American Political Science Association Annual Meeting

September 2026

Measuring Militarization and the Link with Interstate Conflict

Poster presentation at the American Political Science Association Annual Meeting

September 2025

Poster presentation at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference

March 2025

Militarization and Interstate Armed Conflict

Poster presentation at the American Political Science Association

September 2023

Other Professional Experience

The Michigan Daily *Data Editor and Data Journalist*

January 2022 – April 2025

- Researched, wrote, and edited data journalism stories and visuals.
- Led collaboration with other sections of the Daily to produce articles.
- Conducted data analyses and created graphics for publication.

Decision Desk HQ *Data Editor and Election Night Reporter*

November 2018 – November 2024

- Decision Desk HQ reports election results from county election officials. Responsible for a team of editors checking election data results for errors, communicating, and resolving data errors.
- Promoted from Election Night Reporter to Data Editor after four years.

Honors and Awards

Chancellor’s Graduate Fellowship UC Berkeley (\$18000)	2025
David William Bell Fellowship UC Berkeley (\$500)	2025
Pi Sigma Alpha National Political Science Honor Society University of Michigan – Ann Arbor	2024-2025
Nominated for Sweetland Prize for Excellence in Upper-Level Writing Militarization and Interstate Conflict	January 2024
3rd Place, Best Interactive Infographic by Pinnacle College Media Awards How Walkable Is Your Block? <i>The Michigan Daily</i>	November 2023

Skills

Programming: R, Stata, Python, C++, QGIS 3
Quantitative Methods: OLS/Multivariate/Logit/Probit Regression Modeling; Latent variable modeling; Heckman Selection Modeling; Content analysis; Data cleaning